Tae-il Kim

Research Interest: Foreign Aid, Authoritarianism, Governance Building

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Education

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), United Kingdom 2017–2018

M.Sc., International Relations

Thesis: "Re-framing the Ineffectiveness of Economic Sanctions: Power, Identity and the Case of North Korea through a Constructivist Lens"

Pusan National University (PNU), Republic of Korea 2011–2017

B.A., Honors, Global Studies

Thesis: "Security Dilemmas in East Asia: North Korea Factors"

* *Study Abroad: University of Adelaide (Australia), University of Vienna (Austria)*

Research Experience

Research Assistant for Prof. Taehoon Im Feb 2026–Present

Researcher at the Database Center for North Korean Human Rights Sep 2018–June 2019

Research Assistant for Prof. Ryo Hinata-Yamaguchi Sep 2016–Aug 2017

Working Papers

1) Taehoon Im, Sharon Se Yeon Cho, **Taeil Kim**, and Hyunseok Hwang, "From Adoption to Engagement: Determinants of E-Government Engagement Intensity"– ***Under Review (GIQ)*** *[Abstract]*

2) **Taeil Kim**, "Administrative Efficiency without Accountability? Political Regime Effects of E-government on Governance" – ***Working Paper*** *[Abstract]*

3) Seung Deok Seo, **Taeil Kim**, "Staying Registered, Going Quiet: How Restrictive NGO Laws Suppress Civil Society Activity" – ***Working Paper*** *[Abstract]*

Conference

International Studies Association (ISA) 2027, Atlanta, Georgia 2027

• Staying Registered, Going Quiet: How Restrictive NGO Laws Suppress Civil Society Activity (Co-author & Participant

Professional Service & Experience

Korea International Cooperation Agency (KOICA), Tunis, Tunisia 2023–2026

Deputy Country Director – Tunisia Office

• Managed a US$17.73 million portfolio of five governance projects, with a focus on e-governance
• Planned and coordinated eight field study missions in governance and climate-smart agriculture
• Authored a white paper and long-term e-governance roadmap for KOICA Tunisia Office

Korea International Cooperation Agency (KOICA), Seongnam, Republic of Korea 2019–2023

Assistant Manager – HQ (East Africa Dept, Strategic Planning Dept)

• Managed a US$48.96 million portfolio of nine ODA projects across East Africa
• Led annual performance reporting, contributing to consecutive "A" ratings in 2021 and 2022
• Evaluated 80+ new ODA projects for feasibility, strategic alignment, and sustainability

Database Center for North Korean Human Rights (NKDB), Seoul, Republic of Korea 2018–2019

Researcher – Human Rights Division

• Conducted surveys and interviews with North Korean defectors and documented human rights abuses
• Analyzed human rights cases, generated statistical data, and contributed to a research paper

Republic of Korea Marine Corps, Pohang, Republic of Korea 2012–2014
Sergeant – 21th Air Borne Battelion (21BN)

Selected Policy Reports & Field Studies

- "In-depth Study for the Establishment of the Global Center of Excellence in Public Procurement Training (2025-2030)" (KOICA, 2025)
  – Role: Deputy Head of Mission, supported approval of a US$ 11.0 million project
- "Feasibility Study for Climate Smart Agriculture for Enhancing Productivity in Tunisia (2026-2031)" (KOICA, 2025)
  – Role: Deputy Head of Mission, supported approval of a US$ 13.5 million project
- "KOICA Tunisia Long-term E-Governance Roadmap" (KOICA, 2024)
  – Solo-authored, designed a ten-year program roadmap
- "White Paper on E-Governance Program in Tunisia: 10 Years in a Glance" (KOICA, 2024)
  – Solo-authored, synthesized 10 years of program data and drew policy lessons
- "Evaluation Report on the Establishment of Three New Schools for Disadvantaged Students in Jordan (2016-2021)" (KOICA, 2023)
  – Role: Co-evaluator, conducted performance assessment and impact analysis
- My contribution to the United Nations Office for South-South Cooperation *[Open Access]*

Academic Awards and Grants

Graduated with Honors, Pusan National University 2017
Academic Merit Scholarship, Pusan National University 2016
Community Contribution Scholarship, Pusan National University 2016
Academic Merit Scholarship, Pusan National University 2015
Community Mentoring Excellence, Pusan National University 2015
Study Abroad Scholarship, Pusan National University 2015
Academic Merit Scholarship, Pusan National University 2014

Other Activities

UNESCO International Centre of Martial arts (ICM), Evaluator 2023-4, 2026
- Role: Reviewing the ICM Martial Arts Education Prize

Korea National Diplomatic Academy, Participant 2023
- Theme: What shapes the "New Normal" in international relations and governance?

Trilateral Cooperation Secretariat, TCS Young Ambassador 2017
- Theme: Enhancing the relationship among R.O.K.-Japan-China trilateral cooperation

Extracurricular activities, PNU 2014–2016
- Current Issue Studies (CIS); PNU Law Forum; Economic Research Institute at PNU(ERIP)

Skills

Languages: Korean(native), English(fluent–GRE V159/Q165, TOEFL 100), French(intermediate–B1)

Fieldwork: Rwanda(2021), Kenya(2022), Tunisia(2023, 2024, 2025, 2026)

Computing: R, Python, LaTeX, Qualtrics

Data Ability: Certified Social Survey Analyst (Statistics Korea, 2021) | Advanced Data Analytics semi-Professional (ADSP, 2022)

Methods: Causal Inference, Field Study, Interview, Project M&E